

tongue who has mesmerised it with the oldest promise in politics: change.

The election of Barack Obama, born to a Kenyan father, "as Black as pitch", and a Kansas mother, "as White as milk", as the 44th President of the United States is the finest manifestation of what he himself might have called "the audacity of hope". In his victory speech from Grant Park, Chicago, he told 2,00,000 Obamaniacs who had been waiting for the Redeemer's arrival for hours: "If there is anyone out there who still doubts America is a place where all things are possible, who still wonders if the dream of our founders are alive in our time, who still questions the power of our democracy, tonight is our answer." And it was an answer to the speech delivered by a fiery Black preacher called Martin

Luther King Jr from the Lincoln Memorial in Washington DC more than four decades ago: "I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: 'we hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal'. I have a dream that one day on the red hills of Georgia, the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will be able to sit down together at the table of brotherhood..."

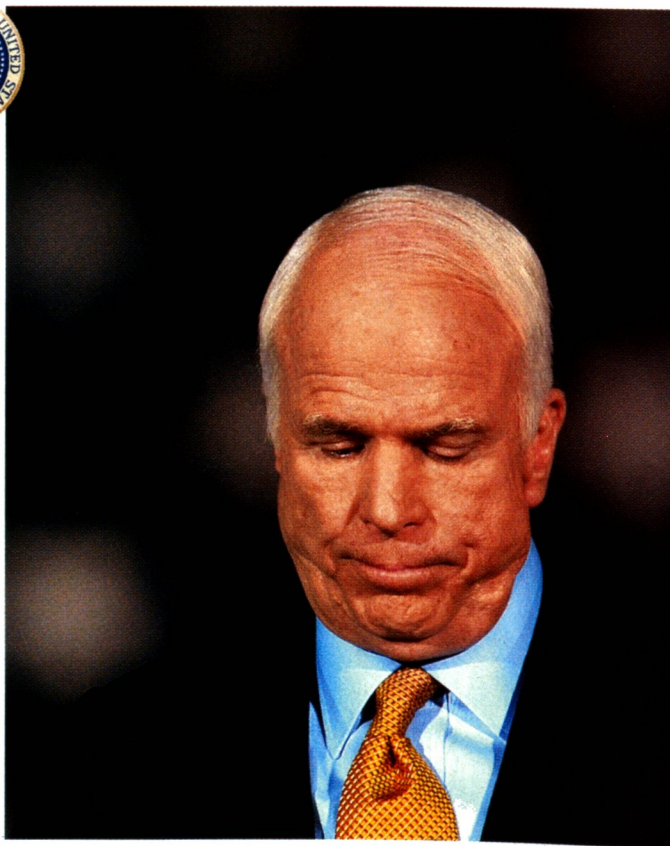
That day would be mythified as 11/4, the day of America's emotional reunification. "America today is a world away from the cruel and prideful bigotry" of another time, as the Republican candidate John McCain, who ran a disastrous campaign, said in his gracious concession speech. The theme of One-America was there in

AMERICA IS IN THE MIDDLE OF A REVOLUTION, SHEDDING ITS RACIAL INHIBITIONS AND DANCING TO THE TUNE OF AN AFRICAN-AMERICAN.



**JOHN MCCAIN
CONCEDES
DEFEAT IN HIS
CONCESSIONAL
SPEECH AT HIS
HOME TOWN
OF PHOENIX,
ARIZONA**

AFP PHOTO / MANDEL NGAN



How Obama

After a 21-month campaign, Obama pulled off the biggest electoral victory since 1996.



WON REPUBLICAN STATES:
Ohio, New Mexico, Iowa, Colorado, Virginia, Nevada and Florida. The first Democrat to win Virginia since 1964.

INTER-RACIAL COALITION:
Included 95 per cent of Black voters and a 2-1 advantage among all other races, including Latinos and Asians.

WOMEN AND NEW VOTERS:
Won votes of 56 per cent of women (53 per cent of the electorate). First-time voters, who made up 10 per cent of the electorate, voted him over McCain by a 3-1 margin.

UNIFIED THE PARTY BASE:
Carried 82 per cent of Clinton's supporters, just 17 per cent broke ranks for McCain.

Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY

Obama's victory speech too, as in his stump speeches throughout: "There are no red states and blue states but only the United States of America... there is no conservative America and there is no liberal America but the United States of America." The margin of his victory—the first candidate to win more than half the national vote (52 per cent) since Lyndon Johnson in 1964—shows the call for oneness worked to a great extent at a time of rising American disenchantment. The America that fell to the left-liberal sorcery of Obama was a lonely superpower on the brink of a nervous breakdown.

In the marketplace, the next Great Depression is no longer a rumour, and